

PROPOSAL · FOR TEAM REVIEW

Regional Pricing for Femi9

Show each visitor a location-appropriate price — automatically, from the first page — done as **regional discounts off one common price**, so the price can only ever go down, never up.

PURPOSE	Align on approach & user flow before we build
STATUS	Draft for approval
DATE	21 July 2026
DECISION NEEDED	Approve approach · pick launch zones · sign off Phase 1 (see last page)

A short, plain-language spec: what we're building, the user flow, how location is detected, the guardrails, and a phased plan.

1 The idea, in one page

We want to show **different prices by region** — e.g. a **Tamil Nadu launch price** vs a standard price elsewhere — **detected automatically** so a visitor sees the right price the moment they land, not only at checkout.

The golden rule (this makes it safe & fair): we keep **one common price (the MRP)** and apply **regional discounts** off it. The **default** — including "location unknown" — is the standard price; regions get **money off**. So a customer's price can only ever **go down**, never up. That's compliant (you can sell below MRP, not above), transparent, and it removes the "price changed at the end = scam" feeling.

Why bother?

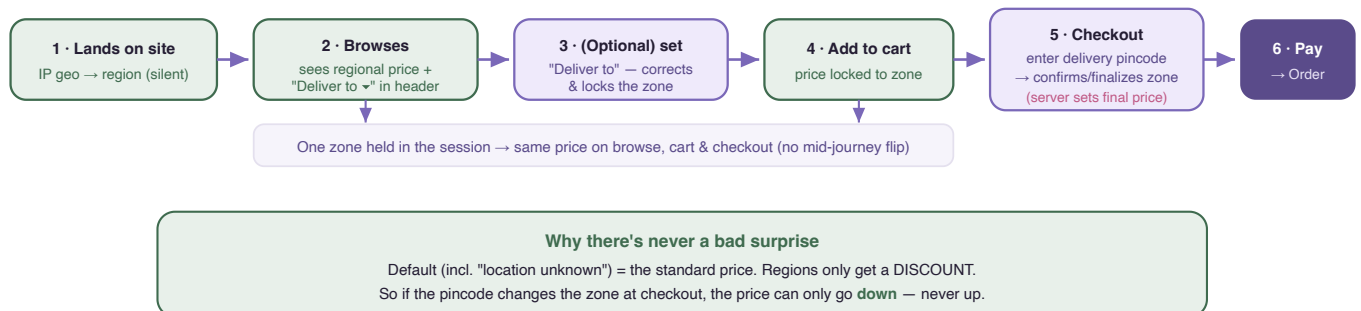
- **Win price-sensitive markets** (small-town / regional launch pricing) without discounting everyone.
- **Localized feel** — "made for Tamil Nadu" pricing builds trust in the home market.
- **A lever, not a rewrite** — turn regions and discounts on/off from the admin, no code deploy.

The one hard part we're solving

The reliable location signal (the **delivery pincode**) only arrives **late**, at checkout — but the price is shown **early**, while browsing. If we waited for the pincode, the user would browse at the default price and see it change at the end. **Our fix:** resolve location **early and silently**, let the user correct it, keep it consistent, and (thanks to the golden rule) make any late change a discount, never a surprise.

2 The user flow

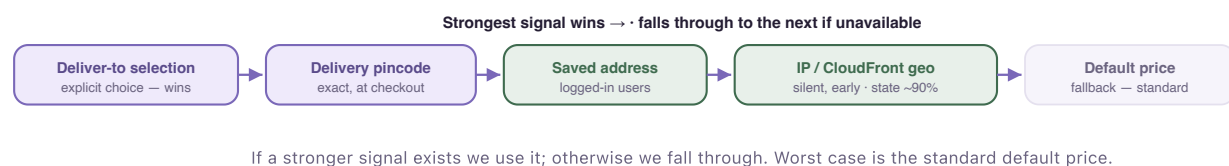
Where the price is decided at every step — and why the customer never gets a nasty surprise.



Location is guessed early (IP), correctable by the user (Deliver-to), held consistent through the session, and finalized by the pincode — which, by design, can only ever lower the price.

3 How we know where they are — the signal ladder

We combine signals, strongest first. Early = a silent guess; final = the delivery pincode.



4 How it works (the short technical version)

Piece	How
Zones	A small set — state-level (e.g. TN , Karnataka , Default), each mapping to states / pincode ranges. Keep it few, not per-city.
Prices	One base price + a per-zone discount (or per-zone price). The final price is computed on the server from the resolved zone — the browser is never trusted. Femi9 already recomputes every price server-side; we make that step zone-aware.
Detect (browse)	CloudFront geo header (free, at the edge) gives country/region on the first request → set the session zone.
Correct	An Amazon-style " Deliver to ▼" widget in the header, pre-filled from geo, that the user can change. Stored in a cookie so browse → cart → checkout stay consistent.
Finalize	The delivery pincode at checkout confirms the zone and sets the charged price (which can only match or beat what was shown).
Admin	Manage zones + per-zone discounts from the Ops console — reuses our editable-settings / coupon system; turn regions on/off instantly.
Caching	Because price varies by region, we add the region to the CDN cache key (or render the price after the geo lookup) so one region's price isn't served to everyone.

5 Guardrails & best practices

- **Discounts, not surcharges.** One MRP; regions get money off. Compliant, fair, and no bad surprises.
- **Keep it small & modest.** State-level zones (not per-city); realistic gaps (~10–25%), not 5x. Big swings on the same product invite screenshots.
- **Show why.** "Tamil Nadu launch price" beats a silent different number — transparency builds trust.
- **Pincode is the anti-abuse anchor.** VPNs can fake an IP; nobody fakes where the box ships. Price the money on the delivery location.
- **Consistency.** The browse price must equal the checkout price for the same delivery area — the session-held zone guarantees it.
- **Don't over-trust city IP.** Mobile/carrier IPs are often wrong at city level — hinge on **state**, confirm with pincode.

6 Rollout plan

Phase	What	Risk / effort
Phase 1 — recommended first	Region auto-coupons on top of one price + the "Deliver to" selector + IP geo. Reuses the coupon system we already have; transparent ("TN launch –15%"); instant on/off per region.	Low · small
Phase 2 — if needed	Full per-zone list prices (a PriceZone model, admin-managed) for finer control.	Medium

Dependency: the free CloudFront geo header only works once we're deployed on **AWS**. Until then, we use an IP-geolocation library locally so we can build and demo the whole flow now — no blocker.

7 Decisions for sign-off

Tick these and we start Phase 1.

1	Approach: regional pricing as discounts off one MRP (default = standard), detected by IP geo + Deliver-to + pincode. ☐ Approve
2	Launch zones: which regions get a special price? (e.g. Tamil Nadu special vs Default.) ☐ _____
3	Discount range per zone (recommend 10–25%). ☐ _____%
4	"Deliver to" widget: soft nudge (optional) or required before browsing prices? ☐ Soft ☐ Required
5	Start with Phase 1 (region auto-coupons)? ☐ Yes